Poplar Dental Practice: patient information knowledge base

Version: 27 October 2026

Sources: the Poplar Dental Practice website (virush007.github.io/poplar-dental-sparkhill), the practice's NHS.uk listing (last confirmed by the practice on 18 September 2026), and its Care Quality Commission (CQC) profile.

Purpose: this document holds everything the practice's website says, organised by topic, so an assistant can answer patients' questions accurately. Each section stands on its own.

How to use this document

These rules are for an assistant that answers patients' questions using this document.

- Answer only from the information in this document. If the answer isn't here, say you don't know and ask the person to call Poplar Dental Practice on 0121 771 3720.
- Don't diagnose or give clinical advice beyond what's written here. For anything clinical, the patient needs to be seen by a dentist.
- If someone describes an emergency, tell them to go to A&E or call 999 straight away. Emergencies include: swelling in the mouth, face or neck that makes it hard to breathe, swallow or talk; swelling around the eye that means they can't open it; bleeding from the mouth that won't stop; or a serious injury to the face, mouth or jaw.
- Never ask people to share medical details in a chat or online form.
- Some facts can change, such as opening hours and whether new NHS patients are being accepted. Say "the practice's latest information says…" and suggest calling to confirm.
- The section "Things the practice hasn't published" lists topics with no confirmed answer. Don't guess about them.

Practice at a glance

Detail	Information
Name	Poplar Dental Practice
Type of practice	NHS dental practice
Address	1 Poplar Road, Sparkhill, Birmingham, West Midlands, B11 1UH
Phone	0121 771 3720 (from outside the UK: +44 121 771 3720)
Opening hours	Monday to Friday, 9am to 1pm and 2pm to 5:30pm. Closed Saturday and Sunday.

Detail	Information
Lunch closure	Closed from 1pm to 2pm on weekdays
New NHS patients	Accepting adults aged 18 and over, adults entitled to free NHS dental care, and children under 18 (last confirmed on NHS.uk on 18 September 2026)
Run by	Dr Atif Khalil, the registered provider with the Care Quality Commission
Team	Two dentists, three dental nurses and a practice manager
Regulator	Care Quality Commission (CQC), location ID 1-198193249
Email	Not published. Contact the practice by phone or through the online registration form.
Website	virush007.github.io/poplar-dental-sparkhill
NHS.uk profile	nhs.uk/services/dentist/poplar-dental-practice/V004866
CQC profile	cqc.org.uk/location/1-198193249

Opening times

Poplar Dental Practice is open on weekdays only.

Day	Opening times
Monday	9am to 1pm, 2pm to 5:30pm
Tuesday	9am to 1pm, 2pm to 5:30pm
Wednesday	9am to 1pm, 2pm to 5:30pm
Thursday	9am to 1pm, 2pm to 5:30pm
Friday	9am to 1pm, 2pm to 5:30pm
Saturday	Closed
Sunday	Closed

- The practice closes for lunch from 1pm to 2pm on weekdays.
- Bank holiday opening times haven't been published. Patients should call to check.
- When the practice is closed and someone needs urgent dental help, they should use NHS 111 online (https://111.nhs.uk/triage/check-your-dental-symptoms) or call 111.

Finding the practice and access

- **Address:** 1 Poplar Road, Sparkhill, Birmingham B11 1UH.

- **Directions:** open directions in Google Maps (https://www.google.com/maps/dir/?api=1&destination=Poplar+Dental+Practice%2C+1+Poplar+Road%2C+Birmingham+B11+1UH).
- **By bus:** there's a bus stop close to the practice.
- **Parking:** the practice hasn't published parking information.
- **Access:** if you use a wheelchair, have limited mobility, or need any other help to visit, call the practice before your appointment so they can make sure they're ready for you.

Registering as a new NHS patient

Who the practice is accepting

Poplar Dental Practice is accepting new NHS patients for routine dental care. This is what the practice last confirmed on NHS.uk, on 18 September 2026:

- Adults aged 18 and over
- Adults who are entitled to free NHS dental care
- Children and young people under 18

Places can change, so the practice confirms each patient's place when they get in touch.

How registering works

1. **Send your details, or call.** Use the short form on the website's New patients page, or call 0121 771 3720 during opening hours. The practice only needs your name and a phone number.
2. **The practice checks it can take you.** They confirm they have an NHS place for you. If they can't take you right now, they'll tell you, and you can find another NHS dentist on NHS.uk (https://www.nhs.uk/service-search/find-a-dentist).
3. **The practice books your first check-up.** They call you back to arrange your first appointment.

People can also register over the phone by calling 0121 771 3720.

The online registration form

The form is on the New patients page: virush007.github.io/poplar-dental-sparkhill/new-patients.html#register.

It asks for:

- Full name (required)
- Phone number (required)
- Email address (optional)
- Best time to call: any time, morning (9am to 1pm) or afternoon (2pm to 5:30pm) (optional)
- Whether an adult (18 or over) or a child (under 18) is registering (required)
- Anything else the practice should know, for example other family members who'd like to register (optional)
- Agreement for the practice to contact you about registering (required)

Don't include any medical information in the form. The practice goes through medical history in person.

The form is sent securely to the practice's appointment system and passed to the practice team. It's used only to contact you about registering. After sending, you'll see a message saying your details have been received and that the practice will contact you to arrange your first appointment. If the form doesn't send, call 0121 771 3720.

What to bring to your first visit

- A list of any medicines you take
- Proof if you get free NHS dental care, such as a maternity exemption certificate, an HC2 certificate or a benefit letter
- Your previous dentist's details, if you have them
- For children, a parent or guardian should come along

What happens at your first check-up

The dentist goes through your medical history, examines your teeth, gums and mouth, and takes X-rays if they're needed. If you need any treatment, they'll explain your options and the NHS charge before starting. For Band 2 or Band 3 treatment, you'll get a written treatment plan.

Treatments

Poplar Dental Practice provides NHS dental care for adults and children. Its NHS.uk listing includes check-ups, fillings, crowns and bridges, gum disease treatment, root canal treatment, scale and polish, tooth extractions, and braces and other orthodontic treatment (listed as a specialist service). Each treatment below has its own page on the website.

Check-ups and cleaning

NHS charge band: Band 1. **Web page:** check-ups-and-cleaning.html

A regular check-up is the simplest way to keep teeth and gums healthy, and to catch small problems before they become painful.

What happens at a check-up:

- The dentist asks about your general health, any medicines you take, and anything you've noticed in your mouth.
- The dentist examines your teeth, gums and mouth, including checking for early signs of mouth cancer.
- X-rays may be taken if the dentist needs a closer look between or beneath your teeth.
- The dentist explains anything they find and agrees a plan with you before any treatment starts.

Scale and polish: if you need it, a scale and polish removes hardened plaque (tartar) that brushing alone can't shift. On the NHS it's part of a Band 1 check-up when it's clinically needed.

How often to come: it depends on how healthy your teeth and gums are. The dentist recommends the right gap for you, which can be anywhere from 3 months to 2 years for adults, and up to 12 months for children.

Children: bring your child to the dentist as soon as their first milk teeth appear. NHS dental care is free for under-18s, and early visits help children feel relaxed in the dental chair.

Fillings

NHS charge band: Band 2. **Web page:** fillings.html

A filling repairs a tooth damaged by decay or a small break, and stops the problem getting worse.

You might need a filling if:

- A tooth is sensitive to hot, cold or sweet food and drink
- You can see or feel a hole, a dark spot or a rough edge
- A small piece of tooth has broken off

Often, decay is found at a check-up before you feel anything at all, which is when it's quickest and simplest to fix.

What happens:

1. The area is numbed with a local anaesthetic so you're comfortable.
2. The dentist removes the decay and cleans the tooth.
3. The tooth is filled, shaped and polished, and the dentist checks your bite feels right.

Most fillings are done in a single visit. The dentist recommends the filling material that's clinically right for your tooth and talks you through the options.

Afterwards: the numbness usually wears off within a few hours, so take care not to bite your cheek or lip in the meantime. A little sensitivity for a few days is normal. If the pain lasts, or your bite feels high, call the practice.

Crowns and bridges

NHS charge band: Band 3. **Web page:** crowns-and-bridges.html

A crown protects and strengthens a damaged tooth. A bridge fills the gap left by a missing tooth.

Crowns: a crown is a cap that covers the whole visible part of a tooth. The dentist may recommend one if a tooth is badly decayed, broken or heavily filled, or to protect a tooth after root canal treatment.

Bridges: a bridge is one or more false teeth held in place by being fixed to the teeth on either side of the gap. It stays in your mouth, so you look after it much like your natural teeth.

What to expect:

1. At the first visit, the dentist prepares the tooth, takes a mould, and fits a temporary crown if you need one.
2. Your crown or bridge is made to fit you by a dental laboratory.
3. At the second visit, the dentist fits it in place and checks your bite.

Looking after them: brush twice a day with a fluoride toothpaste and clean between your teeth every day. Under a bridge, floss threaders or small interdental brushes help. Regular check-ups make sure everything stays healthy.

Band 3 also covers any Band 1 and Band 2 care you need in the same course of treatment.

Gum disease treatment

NHS charge band: Band 1 for simple gum care, Band 2 for more extensive gum treatment. **Web page:** gum-disease.html

Gum disease is very common and often painless at first. Treated early, it can be stopped before it damages the bone that holds teeth in place.

Signs to look out for:

- Gums that bleed when you brush or floss
- Red, swollen or sore gums
- Bad breath or a bad taste that won't go away
- Gums pulling back from your teeth
- Teeth that feel loose

How the practice treats it:

- Showing you the best way to brush and clean between your teeth at home
- A scale and polish to remove the plaque and tartar that cause inflammation
- If the disease is more advanced, cleaning more deeply below the gum line, using a local anaesthetic if needed
- Checking how your gums are healing at a follow-up visit, and referring you to a specialist if needed

Lowering your risk: brush twice a day with a fluoride toothpaste, clean between your teeth every day, and keep up with check-ups. Smoking and poorly controlled diabetes both raise the risk of gum disease, so stopping smoking and managing blood sugar make a real difference.

Root canal treatment

NHS charge band: Band 2 (Band 3 if a crown is fitted afterwards). **Web page:** root-canal.html

Root canal treatment removes infection from inside a tooth, so you can keep the tooth instead of losing it.

When it's needed: inside each tooth is soft tissue called the pulp. If it becomes infected or inflamed, usually from deep decay, a crack or an injury, root canal treatment can save the tooth. Signs include:

- Pain that lasts, especially when you bite or have hot drinks
- Swelling in your gum or face
- A tooth that has darkened in colour

Sometimes there are no symptoms, and the problem shows up on an X-ray at a check-up.

What happens:

1. The tooth is numbed with a local anaesthetic. It should feel no more uncomfortable than having a filling.
2. The dentist removes the infected pulp, then cleans and shapes the narrow canals inside the root.
3. The canals are filled and sealed. Between visits, the tooth has a temporary filling.

Treatment usually takes two or more visits.

Afterwards: the tooth may feel tender for a few days, and everyday painkillers usually help. Back teeth often need a crown afterwards to protect them. Call the practice if you notice swelling or the pain gets worse.

Tooth extractions

NHS charge band: Band 2. Stopping bleeding after an extraction and removing stitches are free. **Web page:** tooth-extraction.html

The practice always tries to save a tooth. When that isn't possible, it removes the tooth carefully and explains how to look after the area while it heals.

Why a tooth might need removing:

- It's too badly decayed or broken to repair
- Severe gum disease has loosened it
- An infection can't be treated another way
- The mouth is crowded and the dentist advises making space

What happens: the area is numbed with a local anaesthetic first. You may feel some pressure, but you shouldn't feel pain. Afterwards, you bite on a gauze pad to help a blood clot form.

Aftercare for the first 24 hours:

- Don't rinse your mouth, so the blood clot can settle.
- Avoid hot drinks, alcohol and smoking.
- Eat soft food and chew on the other side.
- If it bleeds, bite firmly on a clean, damp gauze or rolled-up handkerchief for 15 minutes.
- After 24 hours, rinse gently with warm salty water after meals.

Call the practice if the bleeding won't stop, the pain gets worse after a few days, or you notice swelling. If the practice is closed, call NHS 111.

Braces and orthodontics

NHS charge band: Band 3, and free for under-18s who qualify. **Web page:** braces.html

Straighter teeth can be easier to keep clean and more comfortable to bite with. The practice checks whether braces are right for you or your child, and explains the options.

NHS braces for children: on the NHS, braces are available for under-18s who have a clear clinical need, for example teeth that are badly crowded or a bite that causes problems. Dentists use a standard scale, the Index of Orthodontic Treatment Need, to decide who qualifies. Treatment that's mainly for appearance isn't usually available on the NHS.

What happens:

1. The dentist checks your child's teeth and bite, usually as part of a routine check-up.
2. If braces could help, the dentist explains what's involved and arranges treatment or a referral to an orthodontic specialist.
3. There may be a waiting list for NHS orthodontic treatment, so it helps to ask early.

Braces for adults: NHS braces are rarely available for adults, who usually need to go private. Ask at your next check-up and the dentist will explain what might work for you.

Urgent and emergency dental care

Web page: urgent-care.html

Go to A&E or call 999 if you have

- Swelling in your mouth, face or neck that makes it hard to breathe, swallow or talk
- Swelling around your eye that means you can't open it
- Bleeding from your mouth that won't stop
- A serious injury to your face, mouth or jaw

During opening hours

Call Poplar Dental Practice on 0121 771 3720 as early in the day as you can, from 9am, Monday to Friday. Tell them what's wrong. If they can, they'll offer you an urgent appointment. If not, they'll tell you where else you can be seen.

When the practice is closed

Use NHS 111 online (https://111.nhs.uk/triage/check-your-dental-symptoms) or call 111. They can tell you where to get urgent dental care nearby.

What counts as urgent

- Toothache that painkillers aren't controlling
- Swelling in your gum or face
- A broken, chipped or knocked-out tooth
- Bleeding that won't stop after a tooth has been taken out

If an adult tooth is knocked out

1. Hold the tooth by the white top part, not the root.
2. If it's dirty, rinse it briefly in milk or cold water.
3. Try to push it back into place, then bite on a clean cloth to hold it.
4. If you can't, keep it in milk or inside your cheek, and see a dentist straight away.

Don't try to put a baby tooth back in.

Easing pain until you're seen

- Take paracetamol or ibuprofen, following the instructions on the packet. Don't give aspirin to children under 16.
- Avoid food and drink that's very hot, cold or sweet.
- For swelling, hold a cold compress against your cheek.

Cost of urgent care

Urgent NHS dental treatment costs the same as Band 1, unless you get free NHS dental care.

NHS dental charges

NHS dental treatment is grouped into charge bands. The practice tells you which band your treatment falls into, and what it will cost, before starting.

Band	What it covers
Band 1	Examination, diagnosis and advice. Includes X-rays, a scale and polish, and fluoride varnish if clinically needed.
Band 2	Everything in Band 1, plus fillings, root canal treatment, tooth extractions and more extensive gum treatment.
Band 3	Everything in Bands 1 and 2, plus crowns, bridges, dentures and orthodontic treatment such as braces.
Urgent	Urgent care to relieve pain or stop a problem getting worse. It costs the same as Band 1.

- You pay one charge for each course of treatment, even if it takes more than one visit.
- If you need treatment from different bands, you only pay the highest one.
- Charges are set nationally, not by the practice. See the current NHS dental charges on NHS.uk (https://www.nhs.uk/nhs-services/dentists/dental-costs/how-much-will-i-pay-for-nhs-dental-treatment/).
- For Band 2 or Band 3 treatment, you get a written treatment plan.

Free NHS dental care

In England, NHS dental treatment is free if, when treatment starts, you are:

- Under 18, or under 19 and in full-time education
- Pregnant, or have had a baby in the last 12 months
- Getting certain benefits, such as income-related Employment and Support Allowance, Pension Credit Guarantee Credit, or Universal Credit below a set income, or you're the partner or dependant of someone who does
- Named on a valid NHS tax credit exemption certificate or HC2 certificate

Bring proof to your appointment. If you claim free treatment you aren't entitled to, you may have to pay a penalty. Check who can get free NHS dental treatment on NHS.uk (https://www.nhs.uk/nhs-services/dentists/who-can-get-free-nhs-dental-treatment/).

The team and standards

Web page: team.html

- Poplar Dental Practice is run by Dr Atif Khalil, the practice owner and the provider registered with the Care Quality Commission.

- The team is two dentists, three dental nurses and a practice manager. The names of the other team members haven't been published yet.
- **CQC inspection:** at the practice's last Care Quality Commission inspection, on 4 August 2022, inspectors found the practice visibly clean and well maintained, with infection control that followed national guidance, and staff who knew how to deal with medical emergencies. It was a focused inspection. The CQC doesn't give ratings to dental practices. Read the CQC report (https://www.cqc.org.uk/location/1-198193249).
- **Registered professionals:** every dentist and dental nurse working in the UK must be registered with the General Dental Council (GDC). Anyone's registration can be checked on the GDC website (https://www.gdc-uk.org).
- **Patient reviews:** read reviews or leave one after a visit on NHS.uk or Google.

Feedback and complaints

The practice wants to hear about patients' experiences, good or bad. Most concerns can be sorted out quickly by talking to the practice.

1. **Talk to the practice.** Ask for the practice manager, call 0121 771 3720, or write to the practice at 1 Poplar Road, Sparkhill, Birmingham B11 1UH. The practice acknowledges complaints within 3 working days and explains what happens next.
2. **Or contact the NHS commissioner instead.** If you'd rather not complain to the practice directly, you can complain to NHS Birmingham and Solihull Integrated Care Board, which commissions dental services locally. You can complain to the practice or to the commissioner, but not both.
3. **If you're still unhappy.** You can ask the Parliamentary and Health Service Ombudsman to look into it. Call 0345 015 4033 or visit ombudsman.org.uk.

Complaints should normally be made within 12 months. Free, independent help is available from an NHS complaints advocate, or from Healthwatch Birmingham and Solihull (https://healthwatchbsol.org.uk).

Privacy and your information

- Poplar Dental Practice is responsible for the personal information patients give it.
- The website's registration form collects your name, phone number, whether you're registering an adult or a child, and anything else you choose to share, such as your email address or the best time to call. Don't include medical information.
- This information is used only to contact you about registering and to set up your patient record. It isn't used for marketing and is never sold.
- The website is hosted by GitHub Pages. The registration form sends your details to the practice's automation service (n8n), which saves them to a secure Google Sheet used by the practice team. Google is based in the United States and processes this information with safeguards for transfers from the UK.
- If you become a patient, your details become part of your dental record, which is kept for the period NHS rules require. Form submissions are deleted from the website host once you've been contacted, and the details of anyone who doesn't go on to register are deleted once they're no longer needed.

- The "Ask a question" chat on the website is an automated assistant. It answers using the information on the website and can book appointments, but it can't see patient records. Messages are processed by the practice's automation service (n8n) and by Google's Gemini AI service to write a reply, and are kept for a short time. When someone books, the assistant collects their name, phone number, adult or child, new or existing patient, a short reason and optionally an email address, and saves them to the practice's appointment list and diary (Google Sheets and Google Calendar). Don't share medical information in the chat.
- The website doesn't use tracking or advertising cookies. The map is provided by OpenStreetMap and the fonts by Google Fonts, both of which may see your IP address when a page loads.
- You can ask to see the information the practice holds about you, or ask for it to be corrected or deleted, by calling or writing to the practice. If you're unhappy with how your information has been handled, you can contact the Information Commissioner's Office (https://ico.org.uk).

Things the practice hasn't published

There's no confirmed answer to these questions. Don't guess: ask the person to call the practice on 0121 771 3720.

- Bank holiday opening times
- Parking near the practice
- Detailed wheelchair or step-free access facilities. Patients who need help getting in should call before their visit.
- Languages spoken by the team, or whether interpreters are available
- Private or cosmetic treatments, such as teeth whitening, implants, veneers or clear aligners, and any private prices
- The exact cost of each NHS band. Charges are set nationally and listed on NHS.uk.
- An email address for the practice
- Names, qualifications and GDC numbers of team members other than Dr Atif Khalil
- How long registration or appointments take, or waiting times
- Whether an urgent appointment is available on a particular day
- Sedation, home visits or a dental hygienist service
- Cancellation or missed-appointment policies. To cancel or change an appointment, call the practice.

Frequently asked questions

Q: Is Poplar Dental Practice taking new NHS patients?

A: Yes. The practice's latest information on NHS.uk (18 September 2026) says it's accepting new NHS patients for routine care: adults aged 18 and over, adults entitled to free NHS dental care, and children under 18. Places can change, so the practice confirms each place when you get in touch.

Q: How do I register with Poplar Dental Practice?

A: Fill in the short form on the website's New patients page, or call 0121 771 3720 during opening hours. The practice checks it has a place for you, then calls you back to book your first check-up.

Q: What information does the registration form ask for?

A: Your full name, a phone number, whether an adult or child is registering, and your agreement to be contacted. Email, best time to call and a short message are optional. Don't include medical information.

Q: Can I register my whole family?

A: Yes, you can mention other family members who'd like to register in the "anything else" box on the form, or call the practice on 0121 771 3720.

Q: Can I register my child?

A: Yes. The practice is accepting children and young people under 18 as NHS patients, and NHS dental care is free for under-18s. A parent or guardian should come along to a child's first visit.

Q: When should my child first see a dentist?

A: Bring your child as soon as their first milk teeth appear. Early visits help children feel relaxed in the dental chair.

Q: What are the opening hours?

A: Monday to Friday, 9am to 1pm and 2pm to 5:30pm. The practice is closed for lunch from 1pm to 2pm, and closed on Saturday and Sunday.

Q: Is the practice open on Saturdays or Sundays?

A: No. Poplar Dental Practice is closed at weekends. For urgent dental help when it's closed, use NHS 111 online or call 111.

Q: Is the practice open on bank holidays?

A: The practice hasn't published bank holiday opening times. Please call 0121 771 3720 to check.

Q: Where is the practice?

A: 1 Poplar Road, Sparkhill, Birmingham B11 1UH. There's a bus stop close by.

Q: What's the phone number?

A: 0121 771 3720.

Q: Is there an email address?

A: The practice hasn't published an email address. Call 0121 771 3720, or use the registration form on the website if you're a new patient.

Q: Is there parking?

A: The practice hasn't published parking information. Please call to ask.

Q: Is the practice wheelchair accessible?

A: If you use a wheelchair, have limited mobility, or need any other help to visit, call the practice before your appointment so they can make sure they're ready for you.

Q: How much does NHS dental treatment cost?

A: NHS charges are set nationally in bands. Band 1 covers check-ups, Band 2 adds fillings, root canals and extractions, and Band 3 adds crowns, bridges, dentures and braces. You pay one charge per course of treatment, the highest band you need. The practice tells you the cost before starting. Current prices are listed on NHS.uk.

Q: Who gets free NHS dental treatment?

A: People under 18, or under 19 in full-time education; anyone pregnant or who has had a baby in the last 12 months; people getting certain benefits, or the partner or dependant of someone who does; and people with a valid NHS tax credit exemption certificate or HC2 certificate. Bring proof to your appointment.

Q: What should I bring to my first appointment?

A: A list of any medicines you take, proof if you get free NHS dental care, your previous dentist's details if you have them, and, for children, a parent or guardian.

Q: What happens at my first check-up?

A: The dentist goes through your medical history, examines your teeth, gums and mouth, and takes X-rays if needed. If you need treatment, they explain your options and the NHS charge before starting.

Q: How often should I have a check-up?

A: The dentist recommends a gap based on how healthy your teeth and gums are: anywhere from 3 months to 2 years for adults, and up to 12 months for children.

Q: I have toothache. What should I do?

A: During opening hours, call Poplar Dental Practice on 0121 771 3720 as early in the day as you can, from 9am. If they can, they'll offer an urgent appointment; if not, they'll tell you where else you can be seen. When the practice is closed, use NHS 111 online or call 111. Until you're seen, you can take paracetamol or ibuprofen as directed on the packet.

Q: What if I have a dental problem at the weekend or in the evening?

A: Use NHS 111 online or call 111. They can tell you where to get urgent dental care. For severe swelling that affects breathing, swallowing or talking, bleeding that won't stop, or a serious injury, go to A&E or call 999.

Q: My face is very swollen and it's hard to swallow. What should I do?

A: Go to A&E or call 999 straight away.

Q: An adult tooth has been knocked out. What do I do?

A: Hold the tooth by the white top part, not the root. If it's dirty, rinse it briefly in milk or cold water. Try to push it back into place and bite on a clean cloth. If you can't, keep it in milk or inside your cheek and see a dentist straight away. Don't put a baby tooth back in.

Q: How much does an urgent appointment cost?

A: Urgent NHS dental treatment costs the same as Band 1, unless you get free NHS dental care.

Q: Does a filling hurt?

A: The area is numbed with a local anaesthetic so you're comfortable. Afterwards, a little sensitivity for a few days is normal.

Q: Does root canal treatment hurt?

A: The tooth is numbed with a local anaesthetic, so it should feel no more uncomfortable than a filling. The tooth may feel tender for a few days afterwards, and everyday painkillers usually help.

Q: How many visits does root canal treatment take?

A: Usually two or more visits.

Q: How many visits does a crown take?

A: Usually two: one to prepare the tooth and take a mould, and one to fit the crown once the dental laboratory has made it.

Q: What should I do after a tooth is taken out?

A: For the first 24 hours: don't rinse your mouth, avoid hot drinks, alcohol and smoking, and eat soft food on the other side. If it bleeds, bite firmly on a clean, damp gauze for 15 minutes. After 24 hours, rinse gently with warm salty water after meals. Call the practice if bleeding won't stop, the pain gets worse after a few days, or you notice swelling.

Q: Can my child get braces on the NHS?

A: NHS braces are available for under-18s with a clear clinical need, assessed using the Index of Orthodontic Treatment Need. The dentist checks your child's teeth and bite and arranges treatment or a referral to a specialist if braces could help. There may be a waiting list.

Q: Can adults get braces?

A: NHS braces are rarely available for adults, who usually need to go private. Ask the dentist at your next check-up.

Q: Do you offer teeth whitening, implants or other cosmetic treatment?

A: The practice hasn't published any private or cosmetic treatments. Please call 0121 771 3720 to ask.

Q: My gums bleed when I brush. Should I see a dentist?

A: Bleeding gums can be a sign of gum disease, which is very common and treatable, especially early. Book a check-up with the practice so a dentist can take a look.

Q: Who are the dentists?

A: The practice is run by Dr Atif Khalil. The team includes two dentists, three dental nurses and a practice manager. The other team members' names haven't been published yet.

Q: Is the practice regulated or inspected?

A: Yes. It's registered with the Care Quality Commission. At its last inspection, on 4 August 2022, inspectors found it visibly clean and well maintained, with infection control that followed national guidance. The CQC doesn't give ratings to dental practices.

Q: Where can I read reviews?

A: On the practice's NHS.uk profile and on Google.

Q: How do I make a complaint?

A: Talk to the practice first: ask for the practice manager, call 0121 771 3720, or write to the practice. You can complain to NHS Birmingham and Solihull Integrated Care Board instead, but not to both. If you're still

unhappy, contact the Parliamentary and Health Service Ombudsman on 0345 015 4033.

Q: Can I book an appointment online?

A: Yes. The chat assistant on the website can book a 30-minute appointment on a weekday, between 9am and 12:30pm or 2pm and 5pm. You'll get a reference number, and the practice may call you to confirm. You can also call 0121 771 3720.

Q: How do I cancel or change an appointment?

A: Call the practice on 0121 771 3720.

Q: What languages does the team speak?

A: The practice hasn't published this. Please call to ask.

Q: How is my information used if I fill in the form?

A: Only to contact you about registering and to set up your patient record. It isn't used for marketing or sold. You can ask to see, correct or delete your information by contacting the practice.

Useful links

- Poplar Dental Practice website: virush007.github.io/poplar-dental-sparkhill
- Register as a new patient: virush007.github.io/poplar-dental-sparkhill/new-patients.html
- Urgent dental care: virush007.github.io/poplar-dental-sparkhill/urgent-care.html
- Patient information (charges, complaints, privacy): virush007.github.io/poplar-dental-sparkhill/patient-info.html
- NHS.uk profile: nhs.uk/services/dentist/poplar-dental-practice/V004866
- CQC profile: cqc.org.uk/location/1-198193249
- NHS 111 dental symptom checker: 111.nhs.uk/triage/check-your-dental-symptoms
- NHS dental charges: nhs.uk/nhs-services/dentists/dental-costs/how-much-will-i-pay-for-nhs-dental-treatment
- Free NHS dental treatment: nhs.uk/nhs-services/dentists/who-can-get-free-nhs-dental-treatment
- Find another NHS dentist: nhs.uk/service-search/find-a-dentist